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Andy Cohen Comes Back

Wichita ball fans will welcome the return to Lawrence Field next spring of Andy Cohen, always a popular manager at Denver. Andy, who later went to New Orleans will replace Kerby Farrell at Indianapolis.

Farrell is probably the Cleveland pilot, at least, Hank Greenberg won't say he isn't. However, Hank did say that Farrell would be "protected", meaning he will either be a manager, or a chief assistant at a good salary. It looks like he's No. 1, the announcement being held up pending settlement of a Cleveland newspaper strike.

Indianapolis by the way lost \$9,139 last year under its home ownership system. That isn't much of a loss, but considering that Indianapolis made a sensational climb and won a pennant, then a Junior World Series, the red ink report is no encouragement for those who want to eradicate chain style ball, and get the game back under home town direction and stock ownership of a number of fans.

'Give Us More of TV'

From Pratt, John Stahle writes, saying he's a fanatic for ALL sports and "at times I find myself in disagreement with you, not often but once in a while." Then he tells why, that we are "joining in the mob hysteria in blaming television for all our ills, pains and scarcity of rain."

Well, that's down right bad, especially about the dryness, which, we naively thought, was caused by the atom explosions, rather than TV. However, Mr. Fan, of Pratt, argues vehemently for television. "We should be grateful for the chance to see opera, the classics, bowl games, world series, championship fights, and children's entertainment," he argues.

Then Stahle cites some new facts, which, he asserts, tend to answer the critics who say TV ruins actual attendance at games. He points out the experience out in Washington. There he relates University of Washington started televising home games and had to build a 15,000 stadium enlargement; it started unlimited basketball telecasts of a game "largely attended by school groups".

"After that I couldn't get in, no space available", even in a field house of 18,000 capacity. Local high schools telecast football, and the sport boomed as never before. The Seattle Rainiers televised Wednesday nights, and the second game Sunday, and crowds went up, then they used TV on ALL home games and Seattle outgrew every minor league club in the nation", Stahle writes.

He closes by saying that the "Wichita high schools football and semi-pro ball games would zoom sagging attendance" by more television.

Well, any one want to try it, and foot the bill? St. Paul tried television and its crowds were terrible, even with a team good enough to beat Wichita seven straight, in a battle for a playoff.

Pro football has boomed by the TV route, but it has won over baseball fans in the very large cities. Pro boxing has been knocked out, almost entirely in many spots, by free TV. But hold on, we hear coin-in-the-slot television is just around the bend, and then, we'll see what we'll see. It's still much too early to get the final verdict on what TV will ultimately do for, or to, sports.

Professional football, by the way, usually blacks out its home games, permitting those on the road, only. The Chicago Cubs did that same neat trick. It seems to be one way of creating interest in a sport, without tempting a fan to stay at home.